Weekly GPO Change Review 2026-11-06 (HPMG-REC-CM-002)

Nov 7, 2026 · @Musah

Purpose and scope

This record documents the weekly GPO modified-time check required by section 7 of HPMG-STD-CM-001 (DC Configuration Baseline and Deviation Register), run on 2026-11-06 on DC01 (ad.northstar.test). It found one Group Policy change with no ticket and no explanation. Harbor Point Medical Group (HPMG) is a fictional organization in a home lab; all people and approvals here are fictional.

- **Check run:** 2026-11-06 (evidence EV-0064)
- **Reviewer:** Musah Issah
- **Standard:** every GPO change needs a CHG ticket approved before the change; a change without a ticket is an incident and a deviation.

Results

Three GPOs changed in the review period; one of them has no ticket and no explanation. Modified dates come from the EV-0064 output.

GPO	Last modified	Ticket	Status
Default Domain Controllers Policy	2026-11-02 (DC01 local time, Pacific)	None	Unexplained
Default Domain Policy	2026-11-05 (password policy)	None, made before the baseline was approved	Explained, no ticket
LAB - DC01 Security Hardening	2026-11-06	CHG-0001	Matched to approved ticket

Changes made on 2026-11-05 happened before the baseline and change control process existed, so they are noted rather than treated as violations.

Unexplained change: Default Domain Controllers Policy

The Default Domain Controllers Policy was modified on 2026-11-02 at about 10:34 DC01 local time. No change ticket exists and the administrator does not remember making the change.

On 2026-11-06 a read-only Security log query (EV-0065) searched 09:30 to 11:30 on 2026-11-02 for events 5136, 5137, 5141 and 4739. It found 0 events, and none mentioned this GPO. The log can't say who made the change or what changed. The most likely cause is that Directory Service Changes auditing was not yet enabled on that date; it is enabled now (CHG-0001).

Current settings of this GPO were captured earlier in EV-0054 and appear to match Windows defaults, but that comparison does not prove what the 2026-11-02 change was.

Actions and sign-off

The 2026-11-02 change is recorded as an unexplained change, an incident and a deviation under section 7 of HPMG-STD-CM-001.

- [ ] Record the change as deviation DEV-004 in baseline v1.1, with the cause marked unknown.
- [ ] ISO compares the current Default Domain Controllers Policy settings with the baseline and notes any difference.
- [ ] Raise a retroactive ticket (CHG-0002) that documents the change as found, not as approved.
- [ ] Add group removal events 4729, 4733 and 4757 to AU policy 7.3 and to the weekly query (planned v1.1).
- [ ] Re-run the weekly check on 2026-11-13 and attach the result as new evidence.

Evidence: EV-0064 (weekly GPO check), EV-0065 (Security log query), EV-0054 (as-found settings).

Reviewed by: Musah Issah, 2026-11-07 (lab exercise, fictional HPMG)